Six-Nation Colombo Conference- (10 December 1962)

Pursuant to growing tension between India and China and the war, Mrs. Sirimavo Bandaranaike convened what came to be known as the Colombo Conference, bringing together the leaders of Burma, Cambodia, Egypt, Ghana and Indonesia to mediate and reach a possible solution to the conflict between the two Asian giants. India accepted the principles of the Colombo Conference in toto while China accepted them in principle, as the basis to start negotiation.

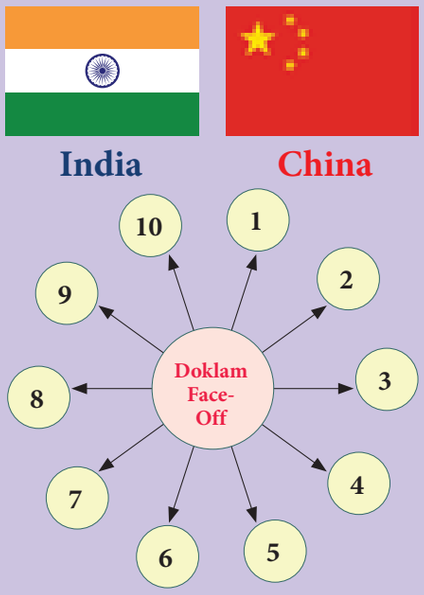
Even until this day, the 1962 Sino-Indian War is a widely debated topic. The end of the war threw a new boundary line between India and China known as Line of Actual Control (LAC). In 1993, an Agreement on the Maintenance of Peace and Tranquility along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) on the India-China border Areas was signed during Prime Minister Narasimha Rao's visit to China. The LAC continues to be a matter of irritation between both countries.

Economic Interests

Since the mid-1980s, India and China started having a closer bilateral economic relations. The process of dialogue initiated by the governments of the two countries helped in identifying the common trade interests. In 1984, India and China entered into a Trade Agreement, which provided them with the status of Most Favoured Nation (MFN). Since 1992, India and China have been involved in a full-fledged bilateral trade relations.

India was the 7th largest export destination for Chinese products and the 27th largest exporter to China. India's top exports to China included diamonds, cotton yarn, iron ore, copper and organic chemicals. China's top exports to India include electrical machinery, equipment, fertilizers, Chinese antibiotics, Chinese organic chemicals. The cumulative Chinese investment in India till March 2017 stood at US$ 4.91 billion and the cumulative Indian investment in China till March 2017 reached US$ 705 million.

Activity



Guided Discussion Teacher divide the class into two groups and ask them to refer e-paper of The Hindu (27.1.2018 – The HINDU Explainer) and Indian Express (28.8.2018 – A Year after Doklam face-off). After reading two Articles by the students teacher can organise the activity in the class.

1. **What is the Doklam issue all about?**
2. **How did it come about?**
3. **Why does it matter?**
4. **Did Bhutan raise it with China?**
5. **When and why, did the face-off begin?**
6. **What were India's concerns?**
7. **When did negotiations between India and China to resolve the crisis begins?**
8. **What arguments did India put forth in these negotiations?**
9. **What led to a breakthrough?**
10. **Had China entered Doklam earlier?**

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